

men, that when a man really **DESIRES** a thing so deeply that he is willing to stake his entire future on a single turn of the wheel in order to get it, he is sure to win. I gave him the opportunity he asked for, *because I saw he had made up his mind to stand by until he succeeded*. Subsequent events proved that no mistake was made.”

Just what young Barnes said to Mr. Edison on that occasion was far less important than *that which he thought*. Edison, himself, said so! It could not have been the young man’s appearance which got him his start in the Edison office, for that was definitely against him. It was what he **THOUGHT** that counted.

If the significance of this statement could be conveyed to every person who reads it, there would be no need for the remainder of this book.

Barnes did not get his partnership with Edison on his first interview. He did get a chance to work in the Edison offices, at a very nominal wage, doing work that was unimportant to Edison, but most important to Barnes, because it gave him an opportunity to display his “merchandise” where his intended “partner” could see it.

Months went by. Apparently nothing happened to bring the coveted goal which Barnes had set up in his mind as his **DEFINITE MAJOR PURPOSE**. But something important was happening in Barnes’ mind. He was constantly intensifying his **DESIRE** to become the business associate of Edison.

Psychologists have correctly said that “when one is truly ready for a thing, it puts in its appearance.”

Barnes was ready for a business association with Edison, moreover, he was **DETERMINED TO REMAIN READY UNTIL HE GOT THAT WHICH HE WAS SEEKING**.

He did not say to himself, “Ah well, what’s the use? I guess I’ll change my mind and try for a salesman’s job.” But, he did say, “I came here to go into business with Edison, and I’ll accomplish this end if it takes the remainder of my life.” *He meant it!* What a different story men would have to tell if only they would adopt a **DEFINITE PURPOSE**, and stand by that purpose until it had time to become an all-consuming obsession!

Maybe young Barnes did not know it at the time, but his bulldog determination, his persistence in standing back of a single **DESIRE**, was destined to mow down all opposition, and bring him